

Card layouts

As mentioned in the previous point, responsive design is one of the foremost Web design trends. To make a website responsive, we have to reposition the column into one, two or three columns based on the screen size. For smaller screens, it is preferable to display the content in only one column. This concept has refocused attention on 'card layouts' as a design pattern for displaying information in bite-sized chunks.

Card layouts were initially popularised by Pinterest a couple of years back and have since become a trend for content-heavy Web pages. The open source jQuery Masonry plugin can be used to design card layouts with dynamic heights and widths. In common card designs, information includes the post title, images or brief descriptions, apart from titles, user names, pictures and various icons.

Material design

Material design is a design language developed by Google. It is a specification for a unified system of visual, motion and interactive design that adapts across different devices and screen sizes. Material design makes more liberal use of grid-based layouts, responsive animations and transitions, padding, and depth effects such as lighting and shadows.

Popular material design frameworks are Material Design Lite (an official Google framework), Materialize, Material-UI, Polymer, Surface, Paper Theme for Bootstrap, Material

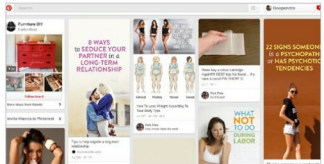


Figure 5: Card layout

Design for Bootstrap, Angular Material, etc.

JavaScript MV* frameworks

JavaScript MV* refers to any framework that implements one of the many MV* (as in, model-view-wildcard) design patterns. There's MVC (model-view-controller), MVVM (model-view-view model), MVP (model-view-presenter), etc.

JavaScript frameworks are a fast growing Web development stack. They help a lot in rapid Web development. These JavaScript frameworks help you to structure your code so that it is scalable, reusable and maintainable. Popular JavaScript frameworks are Angular.js, React, Polymer, Ember.js, Vue.js, Backbone and many more.

Single page Web apps

One of the hottest trends in Web design is to develop a single page website. Over the past couple of years, we have seen that single page websites are a popular choice among Web designers. Single page websites also help to reduce the extra markup from the Web page. When the Web app needs information, it pulls it from the database and pours it into the local mould.

Apart from the top 10 latest open source Web design tools and practices mentioned in this article, some other popular languages and frameworks are Node.js (an event-driven I/O server-side JavaScript environment based on V8), Go and Swift programming languages, the HTML 5 video and player, etc. Do try these hot Web development technologies if you haven't done so already. 

References

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